# Claude usage strategy — modern creative layout for a student coder

## My Claude usage strategy

Student · Coding & Development · Daily · Deep debug + fast answers

Sonnet Standard

### CHOOSE YOUR MODEL

**Haiku**
Ultra-fast for quick lookups & simple fixes
Syntax · Definitions · Flashcards

**Sonnet** — Your primary
Best speed + depth balance for daily student coding
Debugging · Concepts · Review

**Opus**
Most powerful — reserve for complex design
Architecture · Capstone

### EFFORT DIAL

| Low | Standard | High | Max |
|---|---|---|---|
| 10% | 60% | 25% | 5% |
| Quick syntax, one-liners, lookups | Debugging, assignments, concepts | Complex bugs, algorithms, DSA | Final projects, system design |

### DAILY WORKFLOW

| TASK | MODEL | EFFORT | WHY |
|---|---|---|---|
| Quick syntax / error fix | Haiku | Low | Speed over depth — no reasoning needed |
| Understand a concept | Sonnet | Standard | Needs clear explanation + examples |
| Debug a tricky bug | Sonnet | High | Requires deep reasoning over code |
| Write / review assignment | Sonnet | Standard | Good quality without overkill |
| Algorithms & data structures | Sonnet | High | Complex logic needs careful thinking |
| System design / capstone | Opus | Max | Architecture needs deepest reasoning |
| Study / quiz prep | Haiku | Low | Repetitive, low-complexity output |

### AVOID THESE MISTAKES

1. Using Opus for every task — it's overkill for daily coursework
2. Copying code without understanding — ask Claude to explain the fix
3. Max effort for simple questions — adds verbosity, wastes time
4. Vague prompts — share the error, context, and what you expected
5. Over-relying on Claude — use it as a tutor, not a ghostwriter

### FINAL VERDICT

**One model. One effort. Best results.**

Use **Claude Sonnet** at **Standard effort** for 80% of your work — debugging, concepts, code review. Switch to **High** for tough bugs. Reach for **Opus** only on your biggest projects.

Sonnet · Standard effort · Daily coder